

Mizan ميزان

An agent that owns contract review, and knows when not to decide

Reads Arabic, English and bilingual contracts, typed or scanned. Checks every clause against the buyer’s playbook. Approves, negotiates with a redline, or escalates to a lawyer with the exact question.

Mohammad Albeladi · AI trainer, SDAIA Academy and KAUST · 30–31 October 2026

Problem statement

Legal reads every contract by hand, and most of them are routine

- Supplier contracts arrive in Arabic, English or both, often as scans.
- Lawyers spend their time confirming that routine contracts are routine.
- The risky ones look like the routine ones: an uncapped liability, a monthly late charge, personal data sent abroad.

The expensive mistake is a confident approval.

Automating review is easy. Automating it so that nothing risky is signed without a lawyer is the problem we set out to solve, and the number we measure first. Most tools leave that decision to the model.

Proposed solution

Every contract ends in one of three routes, decided by code

Approve

Meets the playbook, and the evidence is on record: every clause read, the cap on our liability quoted. No one touches it.

Negotiate

Major deviations. Mizan writes the redline and the message to the counterparty, citing the contract’s own article numbers.

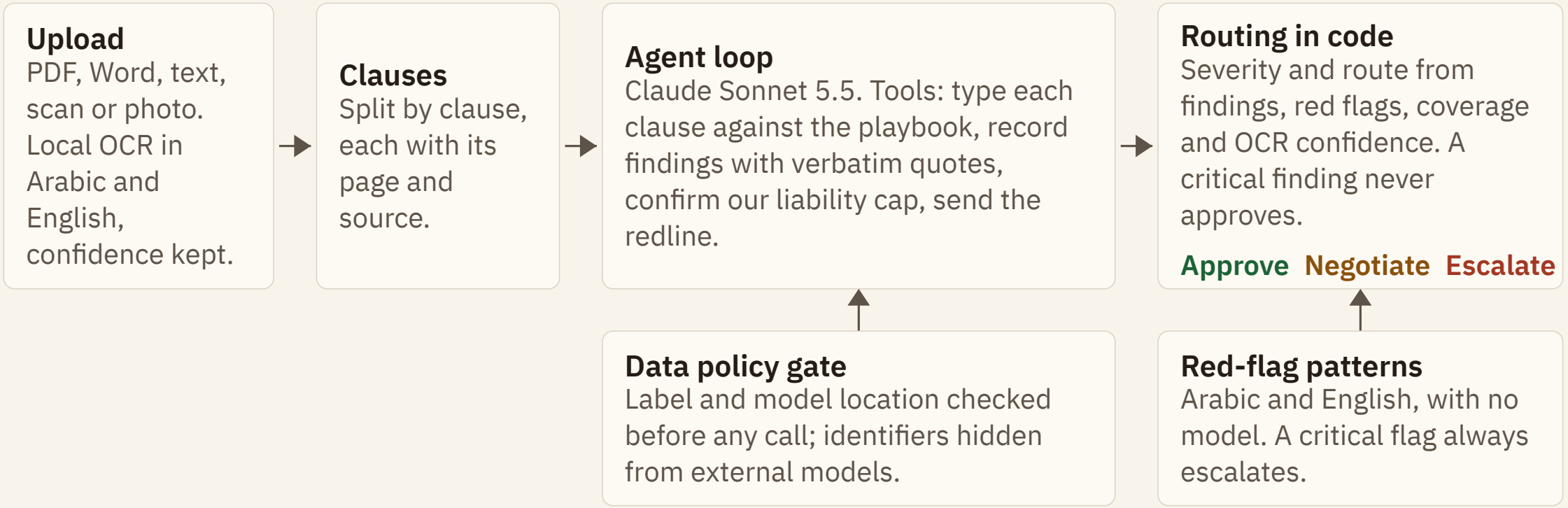
Escalate

Critical risk, a missing clause, an injected instruction, a doubtful scan. A lawyer gets it with the exact question.

The model reads, types clauses and records findings with verbatim quotes. It never chooses the route. Only escalations reach the lawyers’ inbox.

Technical approach

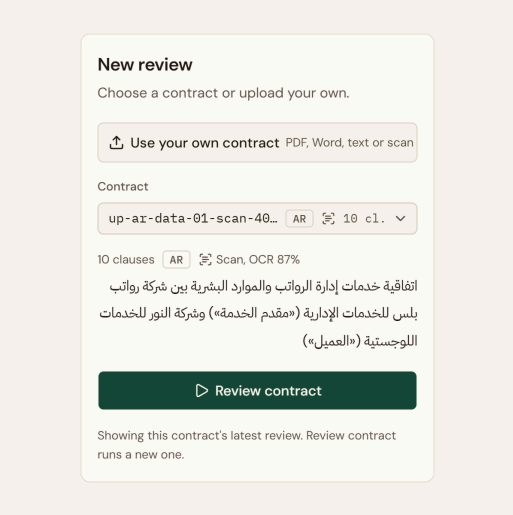
The model reads; code decides

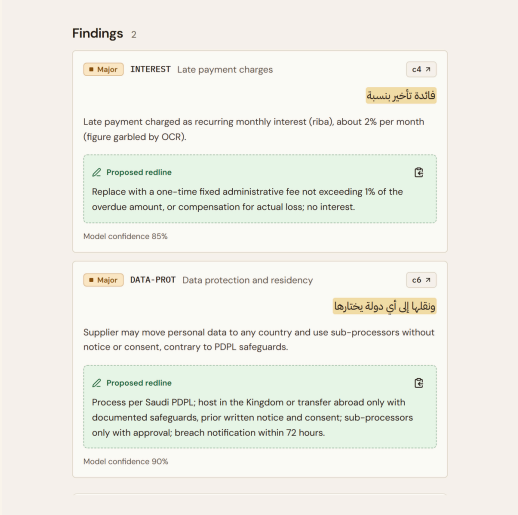


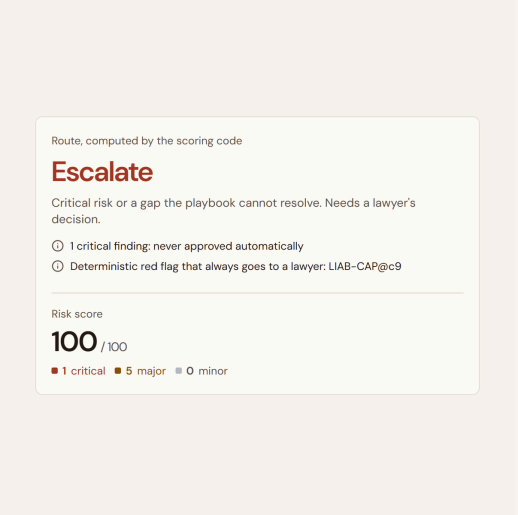
Models: Claude Sonnet 5.5, effort medium, through the Anthropic SDK; or a local model through an OpenAI-compatible server (qwen3:14b measured). Every run has a turn cap, a USD budget and a JSONL trace. Python 3.12, FastAPI, React with Tailwind and shadcn/ui, Tesseract OCR, Typst PDFs, one Docker image.

Implementation

Upload, check every clause, route







1 Bring any contract

PDF, Word, text, scan or photo. Scans are read by local OCR and the confidence is kept.

2 Every clause checked

Findings quote the contract word for word, with the playbook's wording as a redline.

3 Code routes it

Severity and route come from code. A critical finding never approves.

Also built: a lawyers' inbox that holds only escalations, a batch queue with an auto-send policy, redline and memo PDFs typeset from data, a Proof screen with every result, Mizan's own sign-in, and a guided demo that replays recorded runs.

Testing and results

59 contracts, 27 real, every answer key written first

Answer keys are written by reviewers who never saw Mizan’s output and committed to git before the run. Code grades every run, and every result file is kept, the failed first runs too. The newest real batch was also picked by a rule.

Test set	What it is (current version, Claude Sonnet 5.5)	Routes right	Risky approved	Recall	Per contract
Main, 4 runs	12 we wrote and tuned on; the same result in every run	48/48	**0/36**	100%	$0.04
Held-out	12 by a separate agent; 11/12 on its first run, then one fix	12/12	**0/8**	92%	$0.05
Held-out 2	8 more, new industries; run once, blind	8/8	**0/6**	100%	$0.05
Real	15 public, Arabic up to 101 pages; after the fix on slide 9	14/14	**0/14**	73%	$0.23
Real 2	12 SEC filings picked by a rule; run once, blind	11/12	**0/12**	66%	$0.18

Names hidden from the model: 12/12, 0/9, unchanged. Another company’s playbook from a file: 8/8, 0/5. On real contracts it catches liability, interest, indemnity and non-compete issues and misses many termination and payment-term ones.

Innovation and value

Approval needs evidence, not just no findings

Code decides.
A critical finding never approves or negotiates, whatever the model writes.

Coverage, proven.
Every page read, every clause typed, the words capping our liability quoted and verified.

Two detectors.
Arabic and English red-flag patterns run without the model. A critical flag cannot be argued away.

Doubt escalates.
Low OCR confidence, an unclear clause, an instruction aimed at the reviewer, an unfinished run.

What it is worth

- Lawyers see only what needs them; routine contracts are approved with the evidence on record.
- About 5 cents and 17 seconds for a typical contract.
- Arabic and bilingual contracts, and scans read by local OCR with the confidence kept.
- Another buyer’s rules load from a file; lawyers’ decisions become proposed amendments a person accepts.

Innovation and value · data policy

Confidential contracts never leave

Label, suggested from the text	External model (API outside the network)	Model in the network (local or HUMAIN)
Public for a blank template	Reviewed as is.	Reviewed as is.
Internal for names, emails, account numbers	Identifiers become placeholders before sending, and are put back in what people read and send.	Reviewed as is.
Restricted for a confidential marking, an NDA, health data	No model call at all. It goes straight to a lawyer, with the reason.	Reviewed, but never approved or sent automatically.

The label is suggested on this server before any model sees the contract; making it looser is recorded as a person's decision. Enforced twice in code, before the run and in the tool that serves contract text. Every review records the label, how it was set and what was hidden.

Review quality with identifiers hidden: **12/12 routes right and 0/9 risky contracts approved on the main suite, the same as with names shown**

Challenges and future improvements

The first real run approved 5 of 14. One rule fixed it.

5/14

wrongly approved on the blind first run

0/14

after one general rule

On Saudi buyer-side paper the agent read the **supplier's** uncapped liability as the liability clause, so nothing capped **ours**. Approval now needs the words that cap our liability, quoted and verified by code; without them the contract escalates. The earlier suites were re-run afterwards and held. Then 12 new real contracts it had never seen, run once and blind: none approved.

Limits we state rather than hide

- Playbook rules are illustrative, not legal advice. 15 labels come from outside annotators; the rest are ours.
- Recall on real contracts is 66-73%: the routes are safe, but the issue list is not complete.
- No real contract in our sets should be approved, so approving a real compliant one is untested.
- Red-flag patterns catch 1/13 blind; a local model approved 2/8, so local mode needs a lawyer.
- The OCR gate is calibrated on three sample scans; handwriting, stamps and signatures are not read.

Next

- Lawyer-validated labels, including risky Arabic contracts.
- Real compliant contracts, so approvals are tested too.
- Better recall on termination and payment terms.

Conclusion and demo

The model reads. Code decides. Anything uncertain goes to a lawyer.

- Beyond the main suite, 47 contracts, 27 of them real: the current version gets 45 of 46 routes right and approves 0 of 40 risky ones, including the newest 12, run once and blind.
- Arabic, English and bilingual, typed or scanned, up to 101 pages read by OCR.
- Another buyer’s rules from a file, a local model option, and confidential contracts that never leave.
- The main suite gives the same result in 4 runs; 118 tests with no API calls; every number here is reproducible from the repo and on the Proof screen.

Demo

`Demo video link`

About four minutes: upload, the findings with their quotes, the route, the lawyers’ inbox and Proof. The guided demo replays four recorded runs, labelled Replay, with no key and no network.